

This handout is for educational reference only. It is not medical advice. Always follow your prescription label, your pharmacy-specific instructions, and your KORB provider's guidance. If you have questions, contact KORB using the details at the end of this handout.

What Tirzepatide is

Tirzepatide is a dual GIP (glucose-dependent insulintropic polypeptide) and GLP-1 receptor agonist. It works through two separate gut hormone pathways rather than one, which slows digestion and reduces appetite, often more strongly than a single-pathway medication for some patients.

Your tirzepatide is prepared for you by a licensed U.S. compounding pharmacy, which prepares each prescription to your provider's specifications rather than mass-producing it. Because the FDA reviews mass-manufactured products rather than individual prescriptions, compounded preparations are not FDA-approved. The active ingredient is the same one used in the brand-name medication, which is approved for weight management and for type 2 diabetes. At KORB your provider prescribes a compounded formulation that includes a small amount of cyanocobalamin (vitamin B-12) to help with tolerability.

What it may support

This medication is one possible support option for patients with goals related to:

- Weight loss, often more pronounced than single-pathway GLP-1 medications for some patients
- Increased energy as excess weight decreases
- Better sleep quality, for some patients
- Improved cardiovascular health markers
- Support for blood sugar management, if that applies to you

Response varies from patient to patient. Most patients notice reduced appetite within the first few weeks, with weight loss building gradually over months. Tirzepatide is a tool that supports weight loss, not a shot that works on its own. It works best paired with the nutrition and activity habits below, not as a substitute for them.

Nutrition and lifestyle that support your results

These habits help your body respond well to Tirzepatide and reduce the chance of digestive side effects. They are general guidance rather than a meal plan. If you want a plan built around your own needs, a registered dietitian is the right person to see, and your provider can talk through whether that would help you.

- Prioritize protein at each meal. It helps preserve muscle while you lose weight.
- Eat slowly and stop when you feel satisfied rather than full. Tirzepatide slows digestion, so it takes longer to feel full and it is easy to overeat before your body catches up.

- Eat smaller, more frequent meals if large meals feel uncomfortable.
- Avoid greasy, fried or very high-fat foods. These commonly worsen nausea.
- Stay well hydrated through the day.
- Limit alcohol, which can worsen nausea and interferes with steady progress.
- Stay physically active as you are able. Movement supports muscle retention and overall results.
- Prioritize consistent sleep. It supports appetite regulation and metabolic health.

How to use it

Your prescription label, or the instructions given to you by your KORB clinical provider, is the authoritative source for your dose and directions. Some pharmacies label vials "as directed by provider" rather than printing exact instructions. What follows is a general reference. Do not adjust anything without speaking to your provider first.

How to inject	Subcutaneous (SQ) injection — fatty tissue under the skin (abdomen, thigh, or back of the arm)
When to inject	Same day each week, with or without food
Schedule	once weekly

Already taking a GLP-1?

If you are transferring to KORB from another provider and want to continue at your current dose rather than start at the beginning of the ladder, we need documentation of the dose you are on: a pharmacy record, a prescription label, or a note from your prescriber. This is required before we can start you above the usual starting dose, and it is kept in your chart. Without it your provider will start you at the beginning dose and titrate up, which protects you from being started higher than your body has actually tolerated.

Your titration schedule

Your provider starts you at a low dose and increases it gradually, based on how you are tolerating the current one. The exact milligram steps and injection volume depend on which pharmacy fills your prescription, because KORB works with more than one compounding pharmacy and each uses a slightly different concentration and step schedule. Your prescription label always reflects your correct dose and volume for your pharmacy. For a quick reference showing injection volume and syringe markings by pharmacy and dose, ask your provider about KORB's GLP-1 Dose & Injection Guide.

Do not increase your own dose

Even if you feel ready or your symptoms are mild. Increasing too quickly raises the risk of nausea and other side effects. If a dose is not well tolerated, tell your provider; they may extend that step before increasing further.

If you miss a dose

If it has been less than 4 days since your missed dose, inject as soon as you remember, then resume your normal weekly schedule. If it has been 4 days or more, skip it and take your next dose on your regular day. Do not double up.

Storage and handling

What to do	Detail
Refrigerate	36°F – 46°F (2°C – 8°C)
Do not freeze	Freezing damages medication
Protect from light	Keep away from direct sunlight
Discard at 28 days	Write the open date on the vial

Before first use: refrigerate, protect from light, do not freeze or shake.

After opening: write the open date on your vial and discard 28 days after first use, even if medication remains. If your label shows an earlier beyond-use date, follow the earlier one.

Do not use if the solution appears cloudy or discolored, or contains particles.

Traveling with your medication

Traveling does not have to interrupt your program. Keep your medication with you, in your carry-on or personal item rather than checked baggage, in its original labeled vial or packaging. It does not need to be packed in ice during travel; keep it away from excessive heat (above 86°F / 30°C) and from freezing, and refrigerate it again when you arrive. Medication and syringes are permitted in carry-on luggage, and TSA recommends keeping the original pharmacy label visible. Crossing time zones can shift your injection time by a few hours without a problem; if you will be off your usual schedule for several days, contact KORB.

TSA asks that you tell the officer at the start of screening that you are carrying medically necessary liquids, and they may need to be inspected separately. The current rules are at [tsa.gov/travel/travel-tips](https://www.tsa.gov/travel/travel-tips).

What to expect

Timeline	Phase	What to expect
Starting out	First few weeks	Reduced appetite often begins here. Some patients notice mild nausea while their body adjusts.
Titration	Finding your dose	Your dose increases as tolerated, only under provider direction. How quickly you respond depends on your dose and your body.

Timeline	Phase	What to expect
Effective dose	Continued progress	Most of the change happens once you reach a dose that works for you.
Ongoing	Maintenance	Most patients remain on a steady dose long-term to sustain results.

Do not compare your response to others. Response is highly individual and depends on starting weight, metabolism, diet, activity and other factors.

Side effects and what to watch for

What you may notice

What you may notice	What to do
Nausea, vomiting or diarrhea	Common, most often after a dose increase. Smaller, lower-fat meals usually help. Tell your provider if it is severe or persistent.
Constipation or stomach pain	May occur. Stay hydrated and tell your provider if it does not improve.
Low appetite	Expected, and part of how the medication works. Tell your provider if you cannot eat or drink adequately.
Injection site redness or irritation	Some patients notice this. Usually mild. Rotate injection sites.
Headache or dizziness	May occur early on, often from not eating or drinking enough. Usually mild and short-lived.

Tell your KORB provider at your next visit

What you may notice	What to do
Severe or persistent abdominal pain, especially spreading to your back	Can indicate pancreatitis. Tell your provider.
Pain in the upper right abdomen, fever, or yellowing of the skin or eyes	Possible gallbladder problem. Tell your provider.
Unable to keep fluids down for more than 24 hours	Tell your provider.

Stop injecting and seek emergency care immediately if you have trouble breathing, swelling of the face, lips, tongue or throat, a severe rash or hives, chest pain, or any symptom that feels severe or unsafe.

Who should not use Tirzepatide

- A personal or family history of medullary thyroid carcinoma (MTC), a rare thyroid cancer
- A personal or family history of multiple endocrine neoplasia syndrome type 2 (MEN2)
- A known allergy to Tirzepatide or to anything else in the formulation
- Pregnancy, breastfeeding, or planning a pregnancy
- Active gallbladder disease, or a history of complications from gallbladder surgery
- A history of pancreatitis. This needs discussing with your provider rather than ruling you out automatically
- A severe digestive condition such as gastroparesis, where the stomach empties too slowly
- Severely reduced kidney function. Your provider will explain where your kidney results sit
- Uncontrolled diabetic eye disease (retinopathy), which mainly applies if you have type 2 diabetes

Lab monitoring

Routine labs are not required to participate in this program.

- If you are also managing diabetes or pre-diabetes, continue that care, including any related labs, with the clinician who manages it, whether that is your primary care provider, an endocrinologist or another specialist, alongside your KORB visits.
- If your KORB provider has an individual clinical reason to order labs for you, they will explain why and what to expect.

There is no routine draw scheduled for this program.

Safety reminders

- Use Tirzepatide only as prescribed. Do not change your dose, schedule or route without provider direction.
- Do not combine it with another GLP-1 or GIP medication from another source at the same time.
- Tirzepatide is not appropriate during pregnancy or breastfeeding, or with a personal or family history of MTC or MEN2.
- Tell your KORB provider if you develop a new medical condition, start a new medication, or become pregnant.
- Use a new insulin needle and syringe for every injection. Do not reuse.
- Never mix peptides. Use a separate needle and syringe for each peptide and each injection; do not combine them into one syringe.
- Follow your state or local rules for sharps disposal. Use an FDA-cleared sharps container, and do not put used needles or syringes in household trash unless your local guidance specifically allows it.

When to contact KORB

Contact KORB Operations	Patient Portal — message your provider	Seek emergency care immediately
- Questions about timing, storage or administration - Scheduling, billing and shipping Email: info@korbhealth.com Phone: +1 (888) 959-7299 Hours: Mon–Fri, 9 AM–6 PM CT	- Injection-site irritation or redness that does not resolve - Mild but persistent side effects - Questions about whether to continue therapy	- Trouble breathing, or swelling of the face, lips, tongue or throat - Severe rash or widespread hives - Chest pain or fainting - Severe or rapidly worsening symptoms - Confusion or severe weakness - Any symptom that feels urgent or unsafe

The Patient Portal is the only HIPAA-compliant way to message your provider directly. Providers check portal messages once per day on their clinic days. For anything that does not need your provider's direct medical judgment, contact KORB Operations by phone or email instead.

Phone and email are not appropriate for emergencies. When in doubt, go to urgent care or the emergency room.

Key reminders

- Tirzepatide works through two hormone pathways and may support more pronounced weight loss for some patients.
- Dose increases happen only under provider direction. Never increase on your own.
- Write the open date on your vial and discard 28 days after first use.
- Most patients do well when they follow the nutrition guidance above. Tell your provider if nausea is severe or persistent.
- Routine labs are not required for this program.
- Contact KORB Operations for non-urgent questions, your provider through the Patient Portal for medical questions, and emergency care for severe symptoms.